DETECT THE DWELLERS · CHAPTER DICE TEST

A paper test of one idea: **match symbols instead of adding numbers.** Play it, then play today's Quick Shift with the same group, and compare (see *docs/PLAYTEST.md*). Best with **2 players**: solo and 4 players aren't tuned yet.

YOU NEED

This sheet's cards. **Standard d6s in three colours:** crew dice in one colour (2 per player), 3 dice in a second colour for the solo crew die and agent dice, and 2 amber dice for the row. Coins: 2 per player for HP, about 20 to cover symbols.

SETUP

1. Each player picks an analyst. Start at **23 HP**.
2. Shuffle the six mobs face down. The Lockjaw Syndicate goes underneath.
3. Shuffle the 8 agent cards: that's the kit deck. The crew starts with 2 agents (1 solo).

THE KEY

Detect **Contain** **Eradicate**

Every die reads the same: **1–2 Detect, 3–4 Contain, 5–6 Eradicate.** A mob's row of symbols is its hits. Cover a symbol with a coin when you remove it. Bigger crews add the symbols printed for 3 and 4 players.

DOUBLES

Some numbers are **doubles** for you: they're on your analyst card. Hunter 1, 2, 6 · Responder 3, 4, 6 · Engineer 2, 4, 6 · Soarcerer 1, 6 · Fixer 3, 6. On every other die (the solo crew die, agent dice) **only a 6** is a double.

A FLIP

1. Pick who's on point.
2. Flip the top mob. If anything is on the row, roll the row: every row mob that comes back returns with all its symbols. The two with the highest Damage hit everyone on the way in.
3. Fight. When the feed is empty, the boss arrives with one last row roll and no arrival hits.

THE ROW

Roll the **2 amber dice** and add them. A row mob comes back if the sum is **at most its number** ("back on 2–7" comes back on 7 or less).

A FIGHT ROUND

1. **Row.** From the second round on, roll the row first.
2. **Roll.** Everyone rolls one crew die. On point rolls two. Solo: two of your own dice plus the crew die (second colour). Each running Triage Agent rolls an agent die (second colour).
3. **Match.** A die removes one matching symbol from a mob. A **double** removes two of that symbol from one mob, **or guards**: you block this round. Not both.
4. **Hits back.** Every mob still up hits everyone who isn't blocking, for its Damage.

Agent dice can't hit the boss, and can't guard.

AFTER A FIGHT

Beaten mobs go on the row, unless they already came back once: then they're gone for good. Draw 2 agent cards (1 solo) into the tray, which holds 5. Run an agent every round, or burn it once for its big effect. Enrichment's turn keeps a double a double.

WIN OR LOSE

Beat the boss and you've survived the night. Anyone at 0 HP and the shift is lost.

KEYWORDS IN THIS TEST

Beacon: roll the row when it arrives. **Piercing:** blocks don't stop it. **Targeted:** only on point takes its damage, doubled. **Evasive:** only a double can hit it. **Regen:** gets one symbol back at the end of each round. **Escalating:** +1 Damage every round it stays up.

Prototype only. Numbers from the bot sim of 2026-10-30, standard d6 (prototypes/chapter-dice/README.md). Record: who played, time, win or loss, and every rule you played wrong.

IDENTITY · BACK ON 2–8

MAILER DAEMON

DAMAGE **1**



3 players add · 4 players add

1–2 3–4 5–6

Beacon. Roll the row when it arrives or comes back.

MAILER-DAEMON says your message bounced. Click here to retry. You never sent one.

IDENTITY · BACK ON 2–8

PASSWORD SPRAYER

DAMAGE **1**



3 players add · 4 players add

1–2 3–4 5–6

Piercing. Blocks don't stop it.

Summer2026! tries every account in the tower, one a minute. It only needs one to work.

CLOUD · BACK ON 2–6

OAUTH CONSENT GRIFTER

DAMAGE **3**



3 players add · 4 players add

1–2 3–4 5–6

Targeted. Only on point takes its damage, doubled.

A friendly pop-up asks if this app may read all your mail. Someone's thumb is already on Accept.

ENDPOINT · BACK ON 2–7

LIVING-OFF-THE-LAND SCAVENGER

DAMAGE **3**



3 players add · 4 players add

1–2 3–4 5–6

Evasive. Only a double can hit it.

Rundll32, mshta, certutil: every tool it runs is yours. It lives off what already grows here.

NETWORK · BACK ON 2–6

EXFIL COURIER

DAMAGE **4**



3 players add · 4 players add

1–2 3–4 5–6

Escalating. +1 Damage every round it stays up.

rclone.exe is moving 40 GB to a cloud bucket you've never seen. It's still small. For now.

ENDPOINT · BACK ON 2–6

ROOTKIT IMPLANT

DAMAGE **4**



3 players add · 4 players add

1–2 3–4 5–6

Regen. Gets one symbol back at the end of each round.

You count the svchost.exe processes twice. One looks exactly right, and it has teeth.

BOSS · ARRIVES AT 05:59

THE LOCKJAW SYNDICATE

DAMAGE **9**



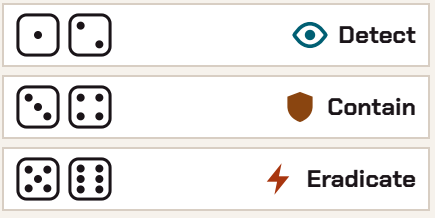
3 players add · 4 players add

1–2 3–4 5–6

Double extortion. +2 Damage until it has lost two symbols. Agent dice can't hit it.

REFERENCE · EVERY DIE

DICE



Your analyst card shows your doubles. Other dice (crew die, agent dice): only a ⚅ is a double.

A double: two of that symbol from one mob, **or** guard. Never both.

Row: roll 2 amber dice; a row mob comes back if the sum is at most its number.

ANALYST · STANDARD D6

HUNTER

Your doubles



Any other number takes one symbol.

Any number you roll is wild against a mob that came back from the row. A comeback you finish is gone for good.

ANALYST · STANDARD D6

RESPONDER

Your doubles



Any other number takes one symbol.

Your Contain numbers (3–4) are wild against the highest-Damage mob, boss included.

ANALYST · STANDARD D6

ENGINEER

Your doubles



Any other number takes one symbol.

Every even number is a double for you: hit twice or guard, more often.

ANALYST · STANDARD D6

SOARCERER

Your doubles



Any other number takes one symbol.

The tray holds one more agent (6). Every won fight draws one more agent card.

ANALYST · STANDARD D6

FIXER

Your doubles



Any other number takes one symbol.

After every fight, heal 5 HP split across the crew. Recovery Agents heal 3 more.

AGENT

TRIAGE AGENT

RUN IT
Rolls an agent die every round.

OR BURN IT
On point rolls 3 more crew dice this round.

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RUN IT
Rolls an agent die every round.

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AGENT

ENRICHMENT AGENT

RUN IT
Once a round, turn one crew die to any symbol.

OR BURN IT
Every die is wild this round.

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ENRICHMENT AGENT

RUN IT
Once a round, turn one crew die to any symbol.

OR BURN IT
Every die is wild this round.

AGENT

CONTAINMENT AGENT

RUN IT
The highest-Damage mob deals 2 less, never below 1.

OR BURN IT
Remove one symbol from every mob (the boss keeps at least one).

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CONTAINMENT AGENT

RUN IT
The highest-Damage mob deals 2 less, never below 1.

OR BURN IT
Remove one symbol from every mob (the boss keeps at least one).

AGENT

RECOVERY AGENT

RUN IT
After every fight, heal 4 HP split across the crew.

OR BURN IT
Heal 6 HP split across the crew.

AGENT

RECOVERY AGENT

RUN IT
After every fight, heal 4 HP split across the crew.

OR BURN IT
Heal 6 HP split across the crew.